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Nyoro marriage and affinity

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There is, then, a manifest ambivalence in the *bwihwa* relationship.¹ For in it are focused a man's relations with the whole group of his mother's agnates, and to this group he is at one and the same time a child whom they have borne, and an 'outsider'. In English terminology, he is at once a kinsman and an affine. And the attitudes and behaviour-patterns appropriate to these two different kinds of relatives are not at all the same. It is not surprising to find, therefore, that the *bwihwa* relationship exhibits aspects both of familiarity and of restraint, and that as in other relationships of potential strain² it is associated with specific ritual prohibitions and obligations. I turn now to consider in detail the interpersonal relations involved, having regard not only to their ambivalent quality, but also to the degree to which they exhibit (if they do so at all) the aspect of superordination and subordination which characterizes the *buko* relationship.

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¹ It combines conjunctive and disjunctive components, to use Radcliffe-Brown's terms ('On Joking Relationships', Chap. IV of *Structure and Function in Primitive Society*, London 1952, p. 95). Like all present-day students of this kind of relationship, I owe much to Radcliffe-Brown's brilliant analyses.

² For example, that between *muko* and *nyinazara*.

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